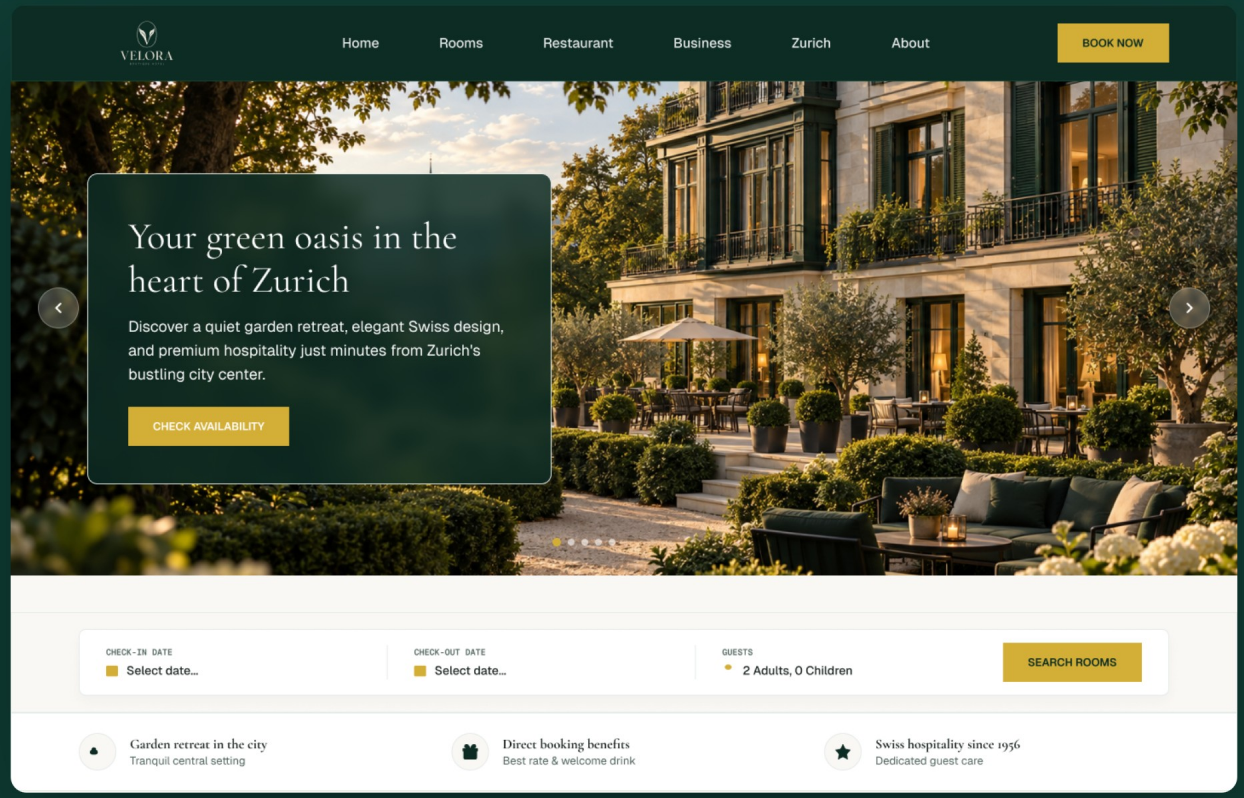
UX/UI REDESIGN ·

Velora

A boutique hotel website, from scattered to bookable

UX audit and full redesign for a boutique hotel in Zurich. Implemented by the client.

Agostina Boris · Name and imagery changed for confidentiality



01 · CONTEXT

A beautiful hotel site that made guests work too hard

A boutique city-and-garden hotel in Zurich, serving leisure and business guests. The site looked premium, but finding key information and booking took too many steps.

MY ROLE

Sole designer: UX audit, information architecture, UI redesign and design system.

SCOPE

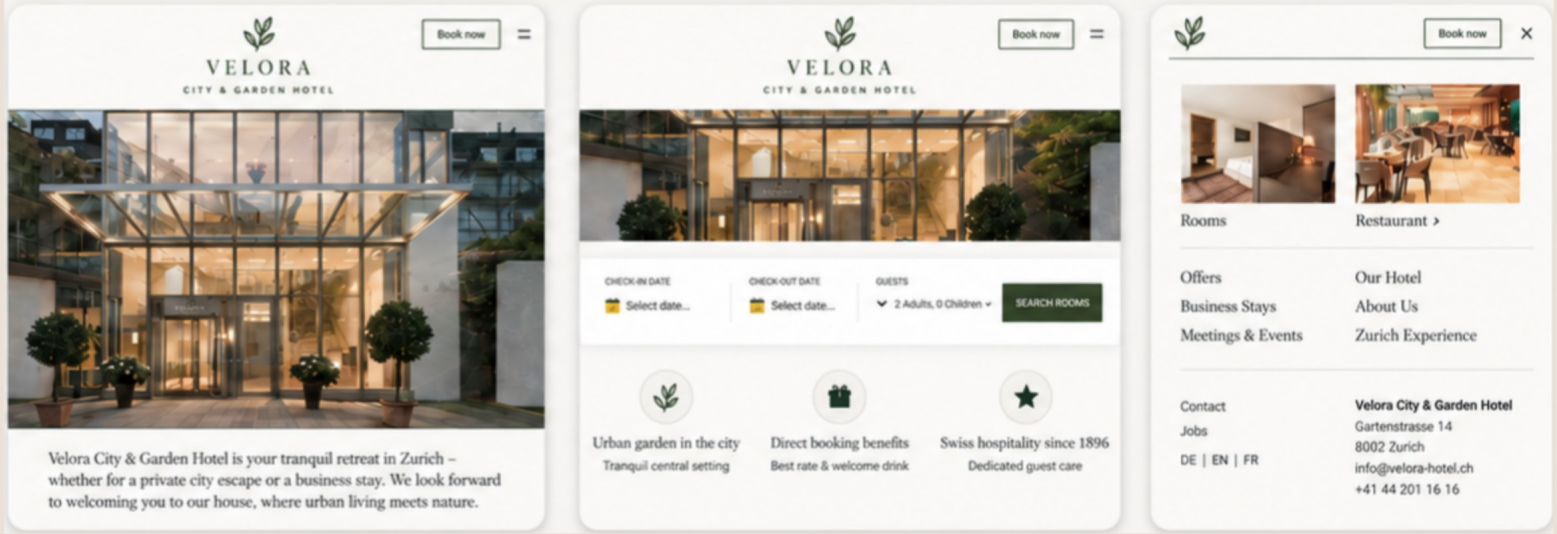
Homepage, rooms, business, restaurant and the booking entry points. Desktop first.

STATUS

Redesign implemented by the client.

02 · THE ORIGINAL SITE

Elegant on the surface, fragmented underneath



Kept: strong visual identity, premium photography, a "Book now" button on every page.

Problem: all sections hidden behind a hamburger menu, even on desktop.

Original screens recreated with Velora branding

03 · HEURISTIC AUDIT

Five issues between a visit and a booking

Hidden navigation

Key sections sit behind a hamburger menu on desktop.

Very long pages

Relevant information takes a lot of scrolling to reach.

Flat hierarchy

Repeated grids give every section the same weight.

Compact layouts

Narrow containers and tight spacing hurt readability.

Fragmented booking

Booking feels separate from exploring the hotel.

KEY INSIGHT

Guests spend too much effort finding what matters most.

04 · BENCHMARK

Strong hotel sites don't show more, they prioritize better

Three Zurich boutique hotels compared on navigation, booking visibility, value proposition and hierarchy.

Visible navigation

Main sections on screen, not in a menu.

Value up front

What makes the hotel different, above the fold.

Grouped by need

Content organized around stay, meet and dine.

Booking in reach

A short, visible path from exploring to booking.

05 · PRIORITIZATION

What to fix first: impact for guests vs. effort for the hotel

Opportunity	Guest impact	Feasibility	Priority
Make navigation visible	High	High	1 · Do first
Strengthen the value proposition	High	Medium	2 · Do second
Improve content hierarchy	High	Medium	3 · Plan next
Simplify booking entry points	Medium	High	4 · Then
Add visual variety	Medium	Medium	5 · Later

06 · GUEST ARCHETYPES

Three guests, three reasons to visit the site

Business traveler

Wants: book fast and find seminar details.

Blocked by: scattered information and long scrolls.

Leisure couple

Wants: feel the atmosphere and compare rooms and dining.

Blocked by: hidden navigation and a buried value proposition.

City explorer

Wants: check the location and nearby attractions, then decide.

Blocked by: long pages and hidden secondary sections.

07 · GUEST JOURNEY

The journey breaks when the next step isn't clear

Step	Friction	Opportunity
Land on the site	No clear value proposition	Say why Velora is different
Explore the homepage	Long scroll, dense content	Highlight what matters most
Find a section	Sections hidden in the menu	Expose the main sections
Compare options	Rooms and seminar info feel scattered	Group content by stay, meet, dine
Check availability	Booking overlay shows too many controls	Fewer steps, less clutter
Decide	Not enough confidence to commit	A clear direct-booking path

08 · INFORMATION ARCHITECTURE

Six top-level sections, always visible

Home
Overview and booking

Rooms
5 room types

Restaurant
Dining, bar, events

Business
4 seminar rooms

Zurich
City guide

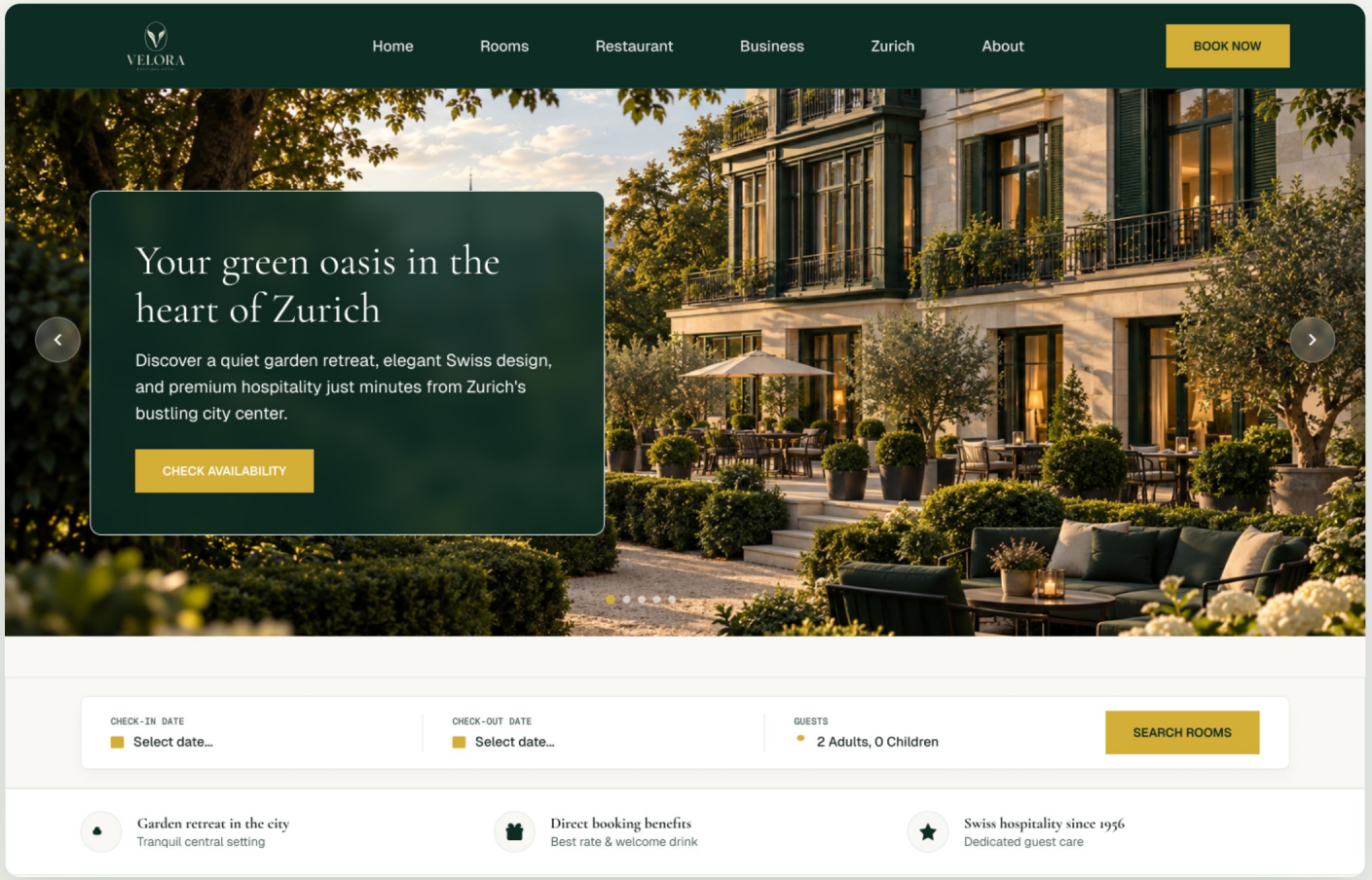
About
Story, team, jobs

Book now stays in the header on every page, and each section opens a second row with its subpages.

DECISION 1 · HOMEPAGE

Show the hotel and the way in, at once

- The hamburger menu became a visible top navigation.
- The hero states the value: a garden retreat in the city center.
- Dates and guests sit right under the hero.



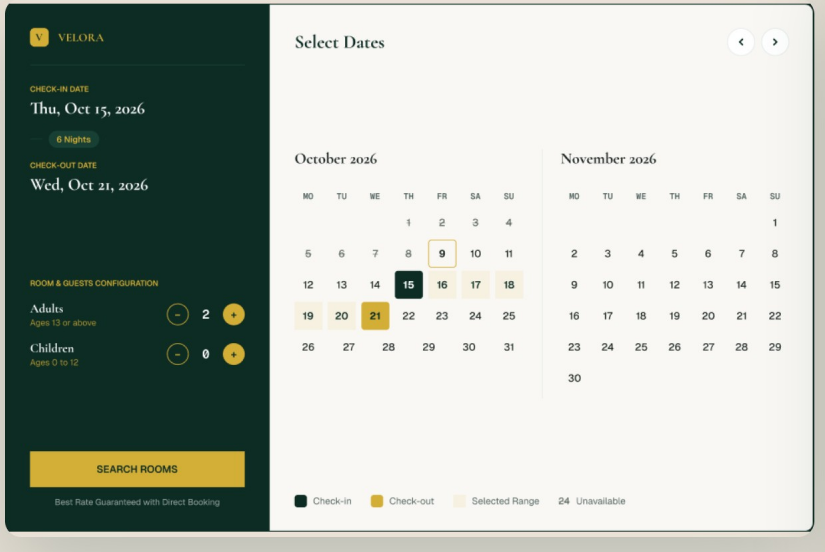
DECISION 2 · BOOKING

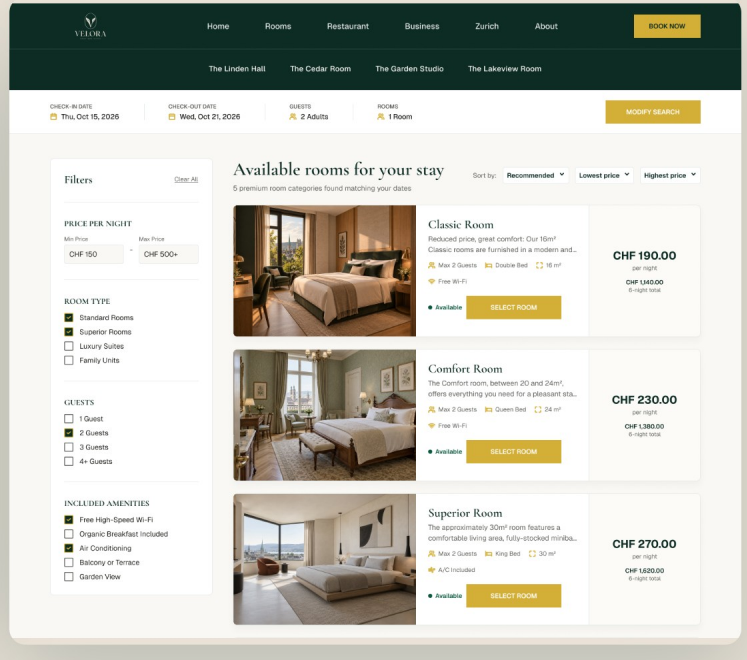
Booking that stays part of the visit

> One date picker shows nights, guests and blocked dates together.

> Results keep the search on top, with filters and the total for the stay.

The hotel's own booking engine stayed out of scope.

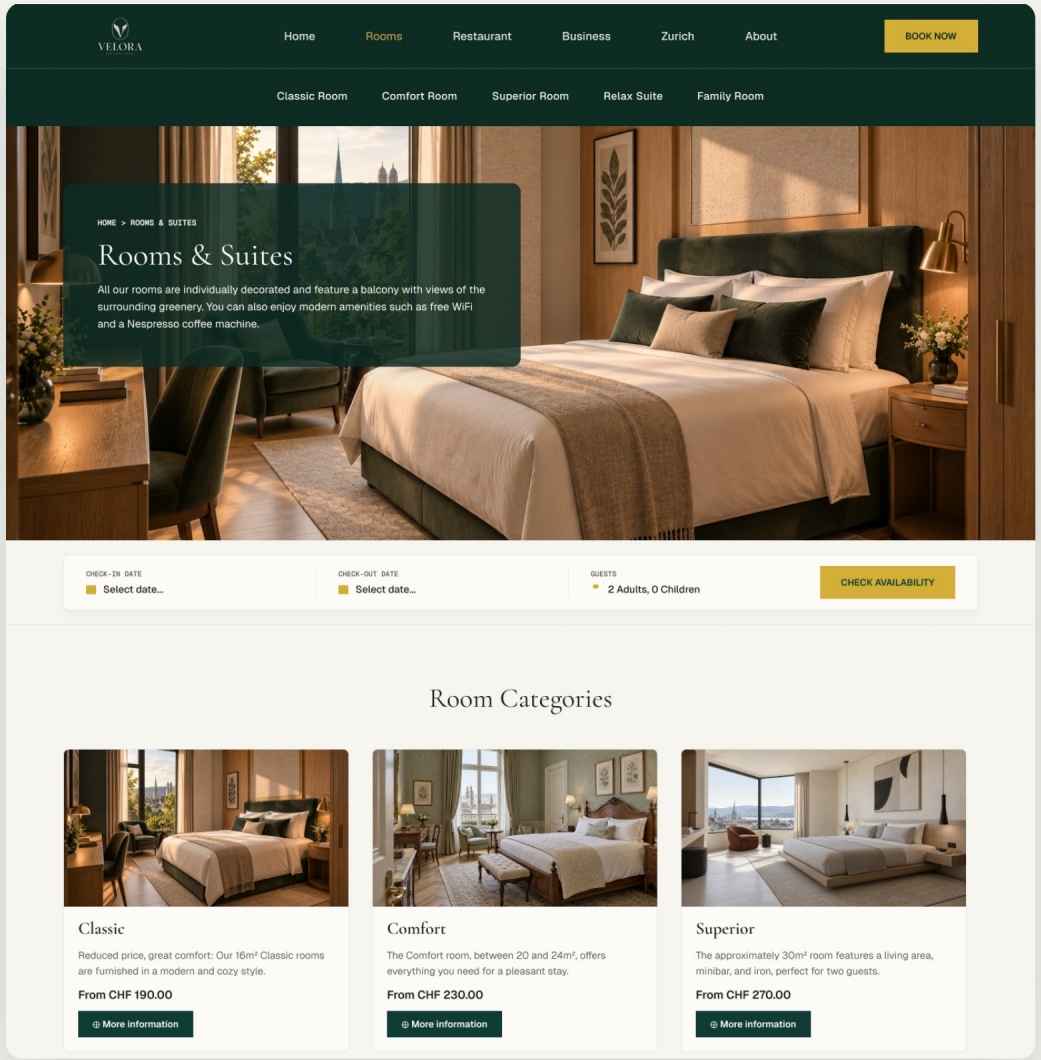




DECISION 3 · ROOMS

Five room types, compared at a glance

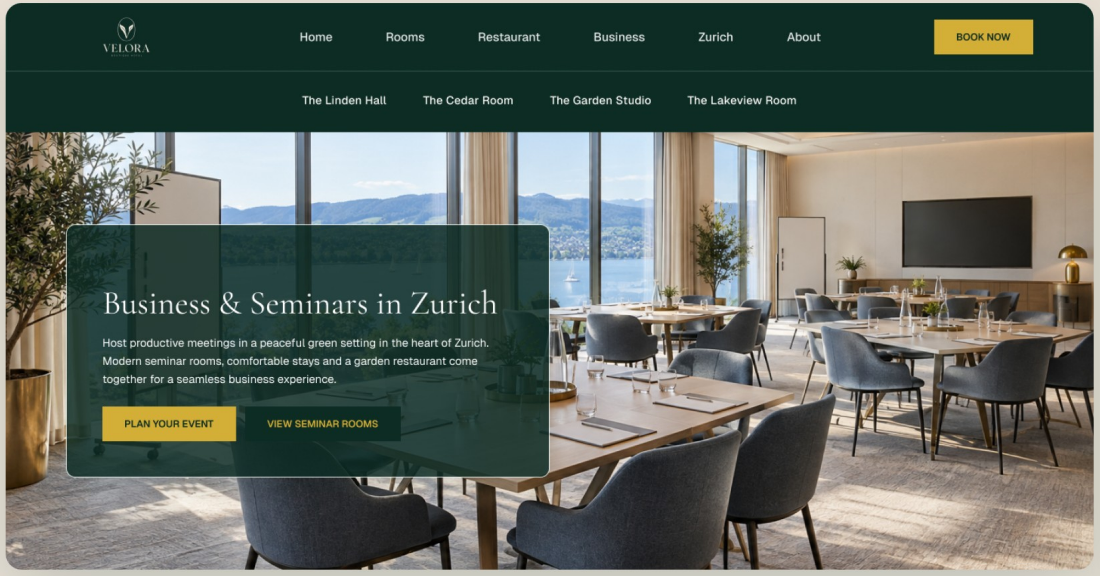
- A dedicated Rooms page, with each room type one click away in the second row.
- Every card follows one pattern: size, short description, starting price and one action.
- The booking bar repeats here, so guests don't go back to the homepage to book.



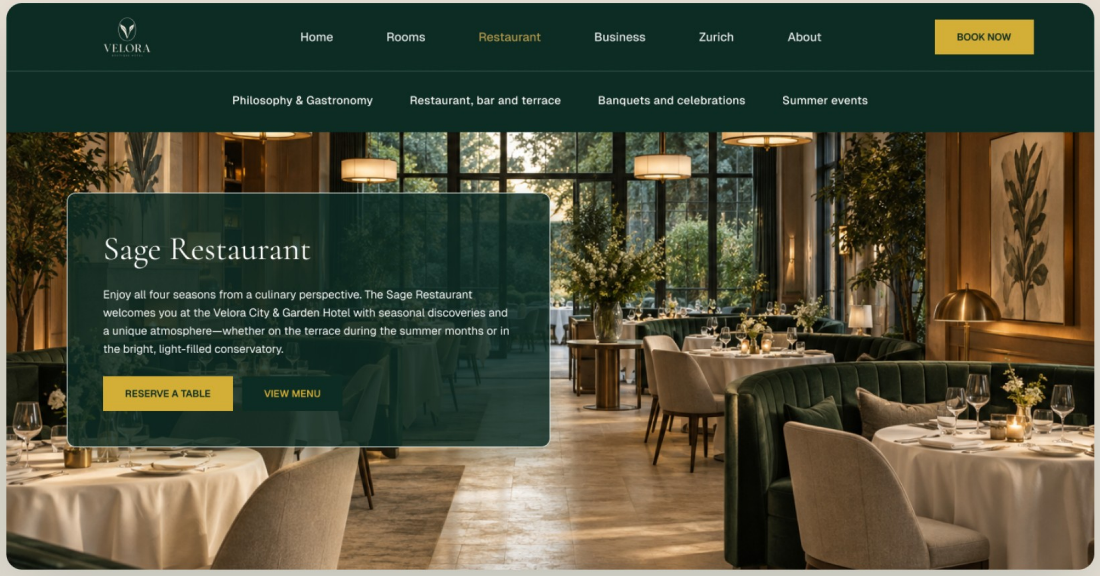
ONE SYSTEM, EVERY SECTION

Built once, reused across the site

A component library with tokens for color, type and spacing, plus buttons, forms and cards, gave every page the same structure.



Business: 4 seminar rooms, packages, inquiry



Restaurant: dining, bar, terrace, banquets

OUTCOME

Same premium identity, a clearer path to booking

The client implemented the redesign.

Visible navigation

Six sections on screen instead of in a menu.

Clearer hierarchy

One focus per section, consistent cards.

Booking in reach

Dates and guests on every key page.

Scalable system

Reusable components for new pages.